CLEO · AI GUIDES

AI for Job Seekers

The AI tools that give you an unfair advantage in your job search — CV tailoring, cover letters, interview prep, and salary research with exact step-by-step exercises.

ChatGPT · Claude · LinkedIn AI · Teal · Perplexity · Interview Prep

Version 1.0 · March 2026 · Not for redistribution

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INTRODUCTION

Most Job Seekers Are Playing Without the Tools That Actually Work.

Sending the same CV to every job posting is the most common mistake in any job search. The second most common: writing a generic cover letter that says nothing specific about the company or the role. Both are easy to fix with AI — and once you see how to do it properly, you won't go back to the old approach.

This guide covers six tools that give you a concrete advantage at every stage of the process. Not theory — exact prompts, exact steps, and examples of what good output looks like. Your CV tailored to the specific job description. Your cover letter specific enough that the hiring manager knows you read the whole job ad. Your interview prep rigorous enough that no question catches you off guard.

Every tool has a free tier. Every exercise uses your actual materials — your CV, the actual job descriptions you're applying to.

How to use this guide

- Have your current CV open in a Google Doc or Word file as you work through Section 1.
- Find 2–3 real job descriptions you're interested in applying for. Use them in the exercises.
- The prompts in this guide are templates — personalise them with your actual information.
- AI output is a first draft. Read it. Edit it. Make it sound like you before you send anything.

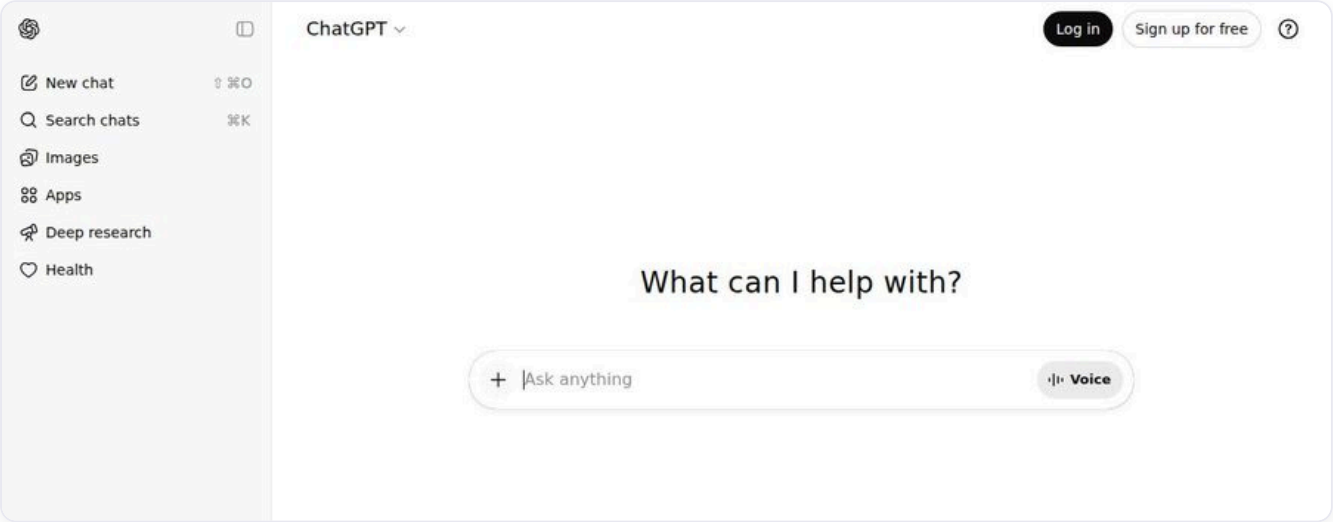
6	25+	3×	$0
Tools covered in depth	Step-by-step exercises	More interview callbacks (tailored CVs)	Cost to try everything

01 CV & APPLICATIONS

ChatGPT for CV Tailoring

Tailor your CV to any job description in 10 minutes — with exact prompts and real examples

Free · Plus plan $20/month for GPT-4o chat.openai.com



ChatGPT at chat.openai.com — paste your CV and job description into a single message using the templates below. The key is being specific about what you want changed.

Tailoring your CV means using the specific language from the job description, making relevant experience more prominent, and removing or downplaying experience that isn't relevant to this role. It takes 30–45 minutes if you do it manually. With the right ChatGPT prompt, it takes 10 minutes — and produces better results because AI catches keywords you'd miss.

Why tailoring matters (and how AI helps)

- **ATS keyword matching.** Most companies use Applicant Tracking Systems that filter CVs before a human reads them. If the job description says "stakeholder management" and your CV says "client relationships," the ATS may not match them. AI identifies the gap and rewrites accordingly.
- **Relevance hierarchy.** Your most relevant experience should appear first and take the most space. AI can reorder and reweight your bullet points to match the priorities of a specific role.
- **Language mirroring.** Hiring managers feel more confident in candidates who use their industry's language. AI matches your writing to the vocabulary of the job description without making it feel forced.

BEFORE (GENERIC)

"Managed a team and oversaw project delivery across multiple departments. Responsible for reporting to senior management."

AFTER (TAILORED)

"Led a cross-functional team of 8 to deliver a £1.2M digital transformation project on time and

7% under budget. Reported directly to the CTO with weekly KPI dashboards."

CV TAILORING PROMPT

```
I'm going to give you two things: my current CV and a job description I'm applying for. Your task is to suggest specific rewrites to my CV that will make it more relevant to this role. Do not rewrite the whole CV. Instead: 1. Identify the top 5 keywords or phrases in the job description that aren't in my CV 2. For each bullet point in my CV that's relevant to this role, suggest a rewritten version that uses stronger action verbs, quantifies the impact where possible, and mirrors the language of the job description 3. Highlight any experience I have that I should move higher up / make more prominent for this role 4. Flag anything in my CV that's irrelevant to this role and could be shortened or removed Here is my CV: [PASTE YOUR FULL CV HERE] Here is the job description: [PASTE THE FULL JOB DESCRIPTION HERE]
```

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Tailor your CV to a specific job description

1. Open your CV in a Google Doc. Select All (Ctrl+A) and copy it.
2. Find a job description you want to apply for. Copy the full description — include requirements, responsibilities, and any "about us" section.
3. Open **chat.openai.com**. Start a new conversation.
4. Copy the CV tailoring prompt above. Paste your CV where it says [PASTE YOUR FULL CV HERE] and paste the job description where it says [PASTE THE FULL JOB DESCRIPTION HERE].
5. Send the message. Read the output carefully. Note: the 5 missing keywords, the suggested bullet point rewrites, and what it flags as irrelevant.
6. Go back to your CV. Make the suggested changes — but read each one before accepting it. If a rewritten bullet point doesn't accurately reflect what you did, edit it so it's truthful.
7. Save this as a new CV file named after the company/role: "CV_CompanyName_RoleName.docx."

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2 Identify gaps between your CV and the job requirements

1. After getting ChatGPT's initial analysis, type: "Now compare my CV against the essential and desirable requirements listed in the job description. For each requirement, tell me whether my CV currently addresses it (Yes/Partially/No) and what I could add or emphasise to address any gaps."
2. Review the gap analysis. For "No" gaps: if you genuinely have that experience, it's missing from your CV and should be added. If you don't have it, note it as a potential interview question and prepare an honest answer.
3. For "Partially" addressed requirements: ask ChatGPT "How could I rewrite this bullet point to more clearly address [SPECIFIC REQUIREMENT]?" Use your own experience as the basis — don't invent experience.

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3 Quantify your experience (if your CV lacks numbers)

1. Paste one bullet point from your CV that describes a responsibility without a number. Example: "Managed social media accounts for the company."
2. Type: "This is a bullet point from my CV. Help me add specific, quantified impact to it. Ask me questions to get the details you need." ChatGPT will ask: How many accounts? What were the follower counts before and after? Did engagement improve? By how much? What was your posting frequency?
3. Answer each question honestly. ChatGPT then produces a quantified version: "Grew combined social media following from 2,400 to 8,900 across three platforms over 12 months, increasing average post engagement by 47%."
4. Work through your 3–4 weakest bullet points this way. Numbers turn descriptions into evidence.

Bottom line: A tailored CV consistently outperforms a generic one — studies suggest tailored applications receive 3x more callbacks. The free ChatGPT tier handles this well. Spend 10 minutes on this for every application and you'll see the difference in response rates within 2–3 weeks.

02 COVER LETTERS

Claude for Cover Letters

A step-by-step cover letter system that produces letters worth reading — not generic filler

Free tier · Pro $20/month claude.ai

Claude at claude.ai — better than ChatGPT for cover letters because it writes with more natural variation and is less likely to produce formulaic-sounding output. Start a new conversation for each application.

Most cover letters fail for the same two reasons: they're generic (the hiring manager can tell it wasn't written specifically for them) and they just repeat the CV rather than adding anything. A good cover letter does three things: shows you understand what the role needs, gives one or two specific examples that don't appear in the CV, and tells the reader why you actually want this job at this company. Claude helps you do all three — faster.

The cover letter structure that works

- → **Opening (1 paragraph).** One sentence on the role and where you saw it. One sentence on why this specific company. Not "I am applying for the role of..." — something that shows you thought about them specifically.
- → **Core paragraph (1–2 paragraphs).** The most relevant experience you have for this role — with a specific example. Not in your CV, or expanding on something that is. What did you do, what was the outcome, how is it relevant here?
- → **Why them (1 paragraph).** Something specific about the company — a product, a recent announcement, a mission statement you genuinely care about. This is the paragraph that separates the 1% of applicants who did their research.
- → **Close.** Brief, confident, not desperate. One sentence on next steps.

COVER LETTER PROMPT TEMPLATE

```
Write a cover letter for the following job application. About me: - My name: [NAME] - Current/most recent role: [TITLE AT COMPANY] - Key experience relevant to this role: [2–3 BULLET POINTS] - One specific achievement I want to highlight (not in my CV or worth expanding): [DESCRIBE IT WITH NUMBERS IF POSSIBLE] - Why I actually want this job at this company (be specific): [YOUR GENUINE REASON] The role I'm applying for: [PASTE JOB TITLE + COMPANY NAME] The job description: [PASTE FULL JOB DESCRIPTION] Instructions for the cover letter: - Length: 3–4 short paragraphs, under 350 words - Tone: confident and direct, not humble or desperate - Do NOT start with "I am writing to apply for..." - Do NOT use the phrase "I believe I would be a great fit" - Do NOT list my skills generically — refer to specific experience - The opening should reference something specific about the company or role - End with a brief, professional close — not "I look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience"
```

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Write your first AI cover letter — from scratch to send-ready in 20 minutes

1. Open **claude.ai** and sign in. Open the job description you're applying to in another tab.
2. Before using the template, spend 5 minutes researching the company: what do they actually do? What's been in the news about them recently? What do they say about their culture on their website? Note 1–2 specific things.
3. Fill in the cover letter prompt template above. Be specific in every field — the more specific your input, the more specific (and convincing) the output.
4. Paste the completed prompt into Claude and press Enter. Read the output slowly, as if you were the hiring manager.
5. Ask yourself: does this sound like me? Does it mention something specific about the company? Does it include a real example with a result? Edit anything that sounds generic or that you couldn't confidently discuss in an interview.
6. Make 3–5 edits to personalise the language. Copy the final version into your cover letter document.

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2 Get Claude to critique your existing cover letter

1. If you have a cover letter you've been using, paste it into Claude with this message: "This is my current cover letter for [JOB TITLE] at [COMPANY]. Critique it brutally. What sounds generic? What's missing? What should I cut? What specific things would make a hiring manager more likely to read it to the end?"
2. Read the critique. It will be direct — that's what you want. Identify the 2–3 biggest issues.
3. Ask Claude to rewrite the weakest paragraph using your feedback: "Rewrite the [opening/core/closing] paragraph with these improvements: [LIST CHANGES]. Keep my voice — don't make it sound corporate."
4. Iterate once or twice until it reads the way you'd want it to sound.

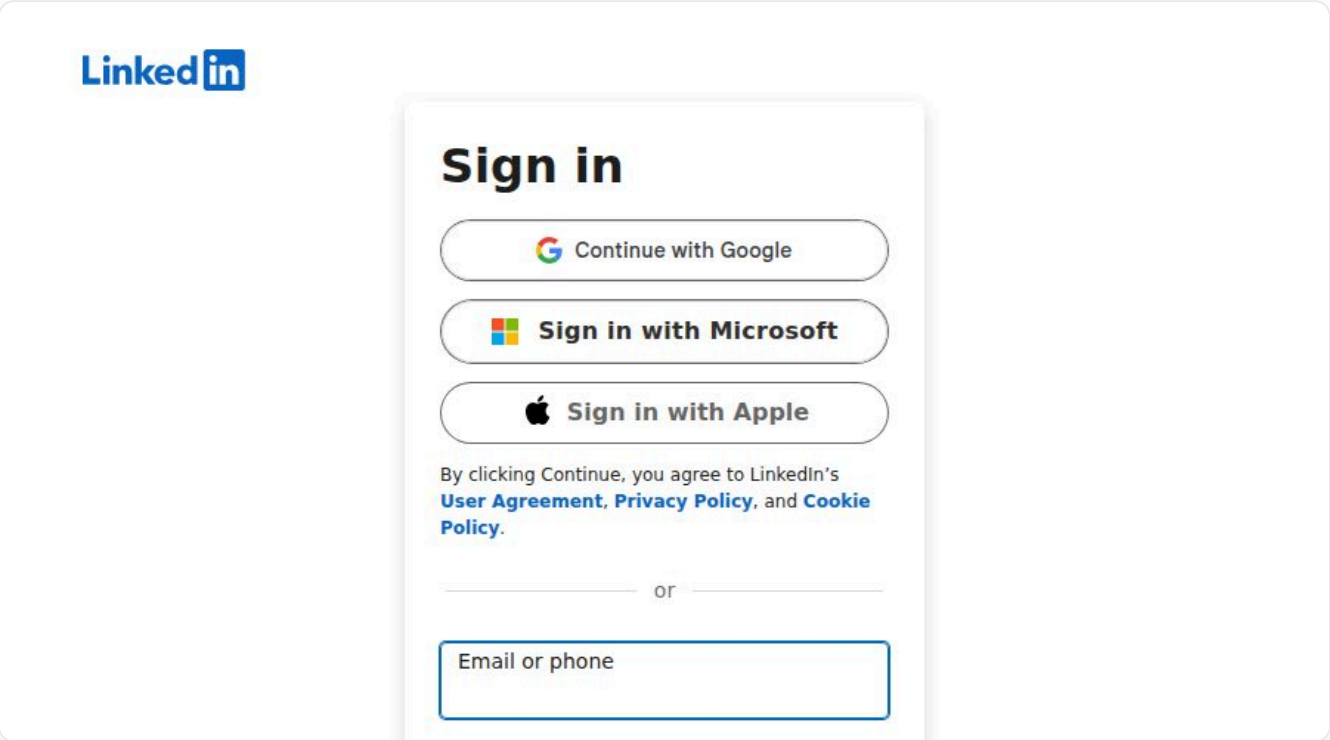
Bottom line: Claude produces better cover letter first drafts than ChatGPT because the output varies more naturally and is less likely to use tell-tale AI phrases. The prompt template above takes 10 minutes to fill in correctly. Do it properly for every application — don't reuse the same letter with a company name swap.

03 PROFILE & VISIBILITY

LinkedIn AI Features

Make your profile findable, write a summary that attracts the right recruiters, and use the AI writing assistant

Free · Premium Career $39.99/month (not required for this guide) linkedin.com



LinkedIn — the writing assistant appears when you edit your profile sections. Look for the "Write with AI" or pencil icon when editing your About section, headline, or experience entries.

LinkedIn is where most recruiters find candidates. A weak profile gets overlooked; a strong one means recruiters reach out to you rather than the other way around. LinkedIn's built-in AI writing assistant helps with the About section, headline, and experience descriptions — and even if you don't have Premium, there's a lot you can do with ChatGPT to write and optimise your profile separately.

The three profile sections that matter most for being found

→ **Headline.** The line under your name — it appears in search results and is weighted heavily in LinkedIn's algorithm. Most people write their job title. Better: your job title + what you do + who for. "Senior Marketing Manager | B2B SaaS | Demand Generation & Pipeline Growth."

→ **About section.** The paragraph(s) that appear under your profile photo. This is where recruiters decide whether to message you. It should say what you do, what you're known for, what you're looking for, and include keywords relevant to your target roles.

→ **Experience descriptions.** Bullet points under each role. LinkedIn's algorithm uses these to match you to job postings and recruiter searches. Generic descriptions ("Responsible for

managing client accounts") are searchable but vague. Specific, keyword-rich descriptions perform better.

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Rewrite your headline to be recruiter-searchable

1. Go to **linkedin.com** and click on your profile photo to view your profile. Click the edit (pencil) icon next to your name/headline area.
2. Note your current headline. Now open ChatGPT and type: "I'm a [CURRENT ROLE] looking for roles in [TARGET ROLE TYPE/INDUSTRY]. My key skills are [LIST 4–5]. Write 5 alternative LinkedIn headline options that are keyword-rich, specific, and more likely to appear in recruiter searches. Each should be under 220 characters."
3. Read all 5 options. Pick the one that's most accurate and sounds like you. Edit it if needed — remove buzzwords that feel hollow.
4. Go back to LinkedIn and paste the new headline into the Headline field. Click Save.

2 Write (or rewrite) your LinkedIn About section

1. Open ChatGPT. Type: "Write a LinkedIn About section for a [ROLE] professional with [X years] of experience in [INDUSTRY/SPECIALISM]. Key strengths: [LIST 3–4]. Currently looking for: [TYPE OF ROLE/NEXT STEP]. Achievements to highlight: [1–2 SPECIFIC EXAMPLES WITH NUMBERS IF POSSIBLE]. Tone: confident but not arrogant, human, not corporate. Length: 3 short paragraphs. End with a clear statement about what I'm open to and how to reach me. Do NOT start with 'I am a passionate...' or 'With over X years of experience...'"
2. Read the output. Mark any phrase that sounds like someone else — change it to match how you actually talk about your work.
3. On LinkedIn, click on your About section and click the edit (pencil) icon. If the **"Write with AI"** button appears, you can also use LinkedIn's native AI to generate a draft — then combine the two outputs for the best result.
4. Paste your final text. Click Save. Check your profile on a phone to see how the text looks truncated — make sure the first sentence is compelling enough to make someone click "see more."

3 Optimise your experience descriptions for search

1. Look at your most recent role on LinkedIn. Copy the existing description.
2. Open ChatGPT and paste: "This is my LinkedIn experience description for [ROLE] at [COMPANY]. Rewrite it to: use stronger action verbs, quantify impact wherever I've left vague language, include keywords relevant to [TARGET ROLE TYPE] — specifically these terms that appear in job descriptions for roles I want: [LIST 5–8 KEYWORDS FROM JOB ADS]. Keep it factually accurate — only enhance what's already there."
3. Review the output. Edit anything that overstates what you did. Accurate and strong is better than exaggerated and discoverable-as-false in an interview.
4. Update the description on LinkedIn. Repeat for your previous 1–2 roles.

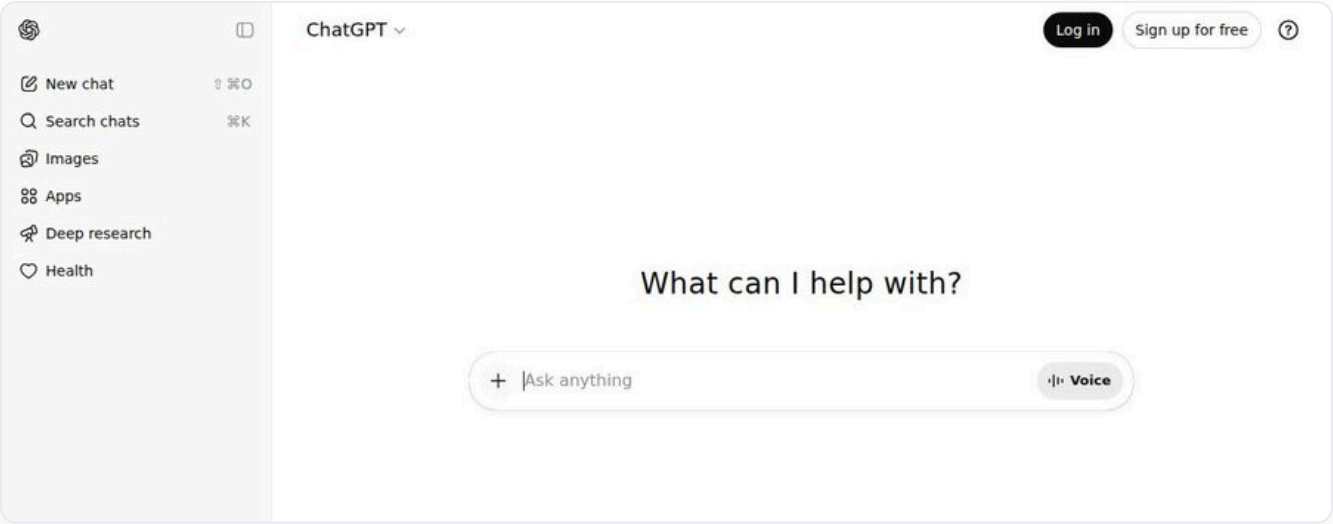
Bottom line: LinkedIn profile optimisation is a one-time task with ongoing returns. A well-written profile means inbound recruiter contact — which gives you far more leverage than cold applications. Spend 90 minutes on this using the exercises above and you won't need to touch it again for months.

04 INTERVIEW PREPARATION

Interview Prep with ChatGPT

Mock interviews, the STAR method, and how to prepare for any question — in 20 minutes

Free with ChatGPT chat.openai.com



ChatGPT as your interview coach — paste the job description and tell it to run a mock interview. It asks you questions; you type your answers; it gives you specific, actionable feedback.

Interview preparation is the area where most candidates underinvest. Reading a list of common questions and vaguely imagining your answers is not preparation — it's the illusion of preparation. Real preparation means practising your answers out loud (or in writing) and getting feedback on them. ChatGPT gives you a mock interviewer available at any time, with specific feedback on every answer.

The STAR method — and how to use AI to structure it

STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) is the structure that makes behavioural answers clear and convincing. Most people know about it. Most people don't structure their answers that way under pressure. AI helps you build STAR answers in advance so you have them ready.

→ **Situation:** Set the scene briefly — one or two sentences. What was the context?

→ **Task:** What was your specific responsibility in that situation?

→ **Action:** What did you do? (This is the longest part — be specific about what you personally did, not what the team did.)

→ **Result:** What was the outcome? Quantify it where possible. What did you learn?

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Run a full mock interview for a specific role

1. Open **chat.openai.com**. Paste the following message, filling in your details and the job description:
2. "You are going to conduct a mock job interview for the following role. Ask me one question at a time. After each answer I give, give me specific feedback on: structure (was it clear and logical?), specificity (did I give concrete examples?), impact (did I show the result?), and tone (was it confident without being arrogant?). Then ask the next question. Start with 'Tell me about yourself' and progress through the types of questions that would be asked for this role.

   Here is the job description: [PASTE JOB DESCRIPTION]"
3. Type your answer to the first question as if you were in a real interview. Don't look things up — answer from memory. ChatGPT gives feedback.
4. Read the feedback carefully. Apply it to your next answer. Work through 8–10 questions. By the end, you will have practised your weakest answers and identified exactly what to improve.

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2 Build STAR answers for your 5 most likely questions

1. Ask ChatGPT: "Based on this job description, what are the 5 most likely behavioural interview questions? [PASTE JOB DESCRIPTION]"
2. For each question, type your rough answer — even if it's just bullet points or a rambling description of an example.
3. Ask ChatGPT: "Structure this into a clear STAR format. Keep the content factual — I'll review it. Make the Action section the most detailed. Add a sentence about what I learned or what I'd do differently if there's space."
4. Read the structured answer. Does the Result sentence include a number or a concrete outcome? If not, think about whether there's one you could add honestly.
5. Save your 5 polished STAR answers in a document. Read them the morning of the interview.

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3 Prepare smart questions to ask the interviewer

1. Most interviewers end with "Do you have any questions for us?" This is not optional — it's part of the interview. Blank looks or generic questions ("What's the culture like?") leave a weak impression.
2. Ask ChatGPT: "Based on this job description and what a [ROLE] professional would genuinely want to know, suggest 8 thoughtful questions I could ask at the end of an interview. Include questions about the team, the challenges of the role, how success is measured, and the company's direction. Avoid generic questions anyone could ask." [PASTE JOB DESCRIPTION]
3. Pick 4–5 that you genuinely find interesting. Research the company before the interview so you can reference specific things: "I read about your expansion into [MARKET] — how does this role intersect with that?"
4. Have your questions written on a notepad in front of you in the interview — it's professional, not a weakness.

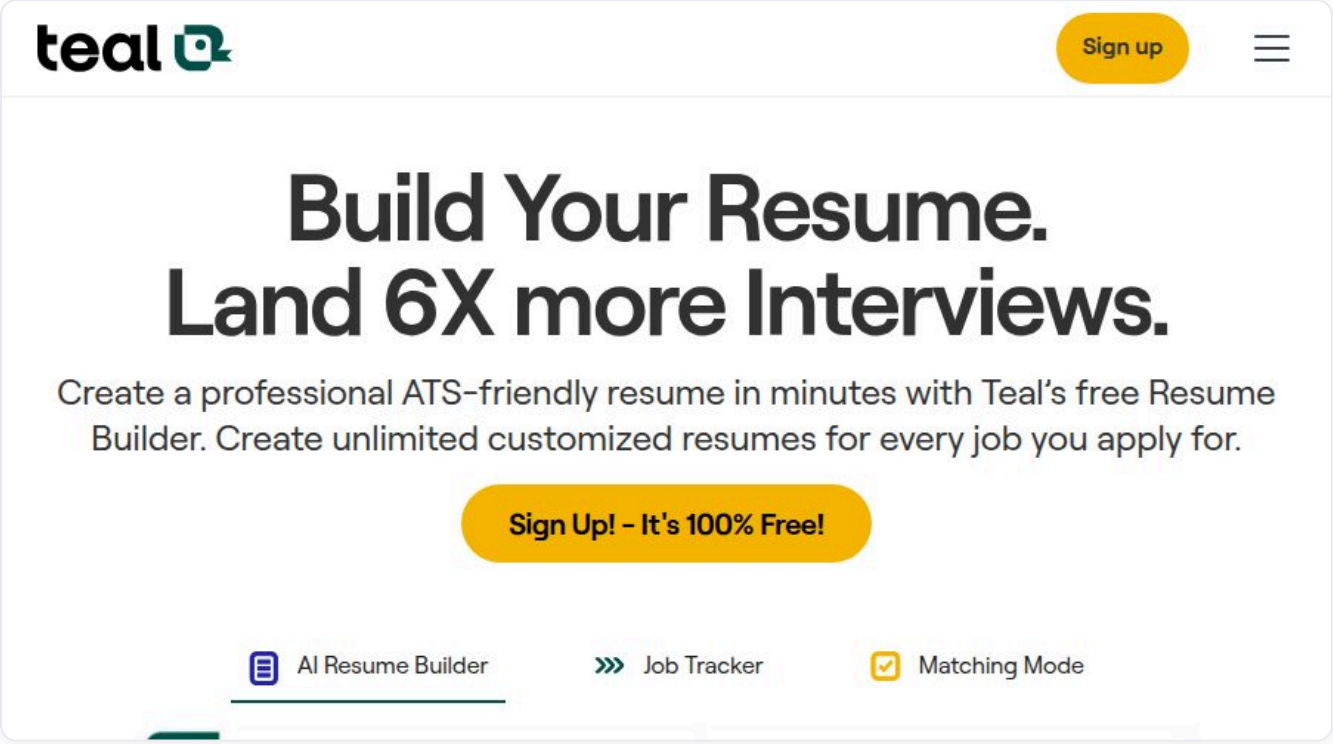
Bottom line: One hour of ChatGPT mock interview prep is worth more than three hours of reading interview tips. The practice loop — answer, receive feedback, improve — is what builds confidence. Do at least one full mock interview before every significant application.

05 JOB TRACKING

Teal for Job Tracking

The AI job tracker that organises your search and helps tailor your CV for each application

Free · Plus $29/month tealhq.com



Teal at tealhq.com — a job application tracker with built-in AI CV tailoring. Save jobs from any site, track your applications through each stage, and get keyword matching against each job description.

Without a tracking system, job searching becomes chaotic within two weeks: you can't remember which version of your CV you sent where, you miss follow-up windows, you accidentally apply to the same company twice. Teal solves the organisation problem and adds AI features — specifically, keyword matching that shows you how well your CV matches each job description before you apply.

What Teal does that a spreadsheet doesn't

→ **One-click job saving.** Install the Teal Chrome extension and save any job posting from LinkedIn, Indeed, or company career pages with one click — it scrapes the details automatically.

→ **AI keyword matching.** Paste your CV into Teal and it shows you what percentage of the job description's keywords you've matched — and which ones are missing. The visual gap analysis is faster than doing it manually in ChatGPT.

→ **Application stage tracking.** Move each application from "Saved" to "Applied" to "Interview" to "Offer/Rejected." The kanban view shows where you are across every application at a glance.

→ **CV builder (optional).** Teal has its own CV builder — useful if you want to maintain multiple

tailored versions in one place rather than managing different Word or Google Doc files.

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Set up your Teal account and import your CV

1. Go to **tealhq.com** and create a free account using Google sign-in.
2. Click **Resume** in the left navigation. Click **Import Resume** and upload your CV as a PDF or Word file. Teal parses it into its builder format — check the imported content for accuracy (it occasionally misreads formatting).
3. Install the **Teal Chrome Extension** from the Chrome Web Store (search "Teal Job Tracker"). This enables one-click job saving from any site.
4. Go to a job listing on LinkedIn or Indeed. Click the Teal extension icon in your browser toolbar. Click **Save Job**. The job appears in your Teal job tracker instantly.
5. Save 3–5 jobs you're genuinely interested in applying for.

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2 Use AI keyword matching before you apply

1. In your Teal job tracker, click on a saved job to open the job detail view.
2. Look for the **Resume Match** or **Keyword Analysis** section (the interface labels this differently depending on your plan). Click it.
3. Teal shows you which keywords from the job description appear in your CV (green) and which are missing (red/orange). Note the missing keywords.
4. Go back to ChatGPT with the list of missing keywords. Ask: "These keywords appear in a job description but not in my CV. For each one, help me find a place in my CV where I could honestly incorporate this term based on my experience. Here is my CV and the missing keywords: [PASTE BOTH]."
5. Make the changes in your CV file. Recheck the match score in Teal after updating.

Bottom line: Teal is free for the core features and genuinely useful for anyone applying to more than 5–6 roles simultaneously. The keyword matching saves 10 minutes per application compared to doing the analysis manually. Set it up once and use it as your job search hub.

06 RESEARCH & NEGOTIATION

Salary Research with Perplexity

Find accurate compensation data — and use it to negotiate from a position of knowledge

Free · Pro $20/month perplexity.ai

Perplexity at perplexity.ai — unlike ChatGPT, Perplexity searches the web in real time and cites its sources. For salary data, this means you get current, sourced figures rather than AI-estimated approximations.

Negotiating salary without knowing the market rate is like negotiating a car price without knowing what the car costs. Perplexity is the right tool for salary research because it searches the web in real time and cites its sources — so you can see exactly where the numbers came from and assess how reliable they are. ChatGPT's salary data can be outdated; Perplexity's is current.

What to research before every offer conversation

→ **Market rate for the role.** What does this specific job title pay at this company size, in this location? Not a broad range — as specific as you can get.

→ **Company-specific compensation.** Sites like Glassdoor, Levels.fyi (for tech), and Transparent California (for public sector) have specific company data. Perplexity pulls from these with citations.

→ **Total compensation beyond base salary.** Bonus structure, equity, pension contributions, benefits. For some roles, these double the base salary figure. Know the full picture before you negotiate.

→ **Cost of living adjustment.** If you're moving between cities or countries for a role, the nominal salary number is less important than the purchasing power it represents.

⚡ Try This — Step-by-Step Exercises

1 Research market rate before your next interview

1. Go to
   perplexity.ai
   (no account needed for basic use).
2. In the search box, type a specific query: "What is the typical salary range for a [EXACT JOB TITLE] with [X years] experience at a [company size — startup/mid-size/enterprise] in [CITY] in 2025-2026? Please include sources."
3. Perplexity returns a researched answer with source citations. Click on the source links to verify the data — Glassdoor, LinkedIn Salary, Robert Half guides, and similar sources should appear.
4. Run a second query: "What does [SPECIFIC COMPANY NAME] typically pay for [JOB TITLE] roles? Any Glassdoor or LinkedIn data?"
5. Build a salary range from the research: a minimum (the number you'd accept), a target (what the market says is fair), and a stretch (the top of the range for your experience level).

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2 Prepare your negotiation response with ChatGPT

1. Once you have salary research, open ChatGPT. Type: "I have a job offer for [ROLE] at [COMPANY]. The offer is [OFFERED SALARY]. Based on market research, the range for this role in [CITY] is [RESEARCH RANGE]. I want to negotiate to [TARGET SALARY]. Write a brief, professional response I could say on a call or put in an email that: states my target number clearly, references the market data briefly without being confrontational, and expresses genuine enthusiasm for the role."
2. Read the draft. Does it state your number clearly? (The biggest mistake in negotiation is being vague about what you're asking for.) Does it maintain a positive tone?
3. Edit to match your voice. Practise saying it out loud — you'll be delivering it on a call, not reading from a script.
4. Key rule: always respond to an initial offer. The vast majority of offers have room in them. The cost of asking is zero; the cost of not asking is potentially thousands per year.

Bottom line: Most people leave money on the table by not knowing the market rate and not asking for more. 30 minutes of Perplexity research before every offer conversation gives you the data to negotiate confidently. Use the ChatGPT negotiation script exercise to prepare exactly what to say.

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

Your AI Job Search System

A complete workflow from finding a role to accepting an offer — using all six tools at the right moment in the process.

01

FINDING ROLES · TEAL

Curate, don't mass-apply

Save interesting roles in Teal as you find them. Review your saved list weekly — remove roles that no longer fit, prioritise the strongest matches. A focused search of 15–20 live applications beats 100 untailored applications every time.

02

CV TAILORING · CHATGPT + TEAL

Tailor for every application — 10 minutes each

Before applying to each role, run the Teal keyword analysis. Take the gap to ChatGPT and use the tailoring prompt. Save a named copy of your CV (Company_Role_CV.pdf) in Teal. Never send the same unmodified CV twice.

03

COVER LETTER · CLAUDE

15 minutes of genuine specificity per application

Use the Claude cover letter template. Spend 5 minutes researching the company before filling it in. One specific detail about the company — a product, a mission statement, a recent news item — separates your letter from every other applicant's.

04

INTERVIEW PREP · CHATGPT

Mock interview the evening before

The night before every interview, run a 45-minute mock interview session. Build your STAR answers for the 5 most likely questions. Prepare 5 questions to ask. Read your answers the morning of the interview.

05

OFFER · PERPLEXITY + CHATGPT

Research before you respond — always negotiate

When an offer comes in, don't respond same-day if you can help it. Research the market rate in Perplexity. Prepare your negotiation script in ChatGPT. Then respond with a clear, specific ask — even if only £3,000–5,000 above the offer. Most companies expect it.

FINAL WORD

The job market is competitive. Your tools don't have to be your disadvantage.

Job searching is one of the highest-stakes activities most people do — and one where small advantages compound quickly. A CV tailored to a job description generates more callbacks. A cover letter that references something specific about the company gets read more carefully. An interview where you've practised your answers feels fundamentally different from one where you haven't.

None of these tools replace the thing that actually gets you the job: being genuinely good at what you do and communicating it clearly. They remove the mechanical barriers — the blank page, the generic language, the vague impression left by an untailored application — so the thing that's actually good about you gets through.

Pick one tool from this guide and apply it to your next application. If tailoring your CV takes 10 minutes and you get a callback you wouldn't have otherwise — that's the argument made.

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